and the hospital or poorhouse. The women were all spinning or carding in one large room. As their spinning was of various kinds, there was a room with cupboards, where each person's work was laid up separately. The task for each man or woman was eight creutzers, or threepence halfpenny a day. Here is a Roman Catholic chapel, and the priest lives in the house. Roman Catholic prisoners are sometimes sent hither from other countries, for their term of confinement, as those of a different persuasion are sent to Bayreuth.

HANAU. At Hanau, the galley-slaves (so-called) are distinguished into *honnêtes* and *déshonnêtes*. The former are condemned for three, four, seven, nine, fourteen years, according to their crimes; but the term is sometimes shortened on account of good behaviour. These wear a brown uniform; and a small chain from the girdle to one leg. The latter are such as have committed capital offences.

The *déshonnêtes* are not doomed to despair: but for good behaviour are sometimes promoted to the rank of *honnêtes*. I conversed with one, whom I found very cheerful for a late advancement of that kind: in consequence of it, he was working on the road.

MANHEIM. At Manheim, Monsieur Babo, counsellor to the regency, very politely gave orders to show me every room of La Maison de Force. Prisoners committed to this house are commonly received in form with what is called the *bien-venu* (welcome). A machine is brought out, in which are fastened their neck, hands, and feet. Then they are stripped; and have, according as the magistrate orders—the *grand venu* of twenty to thirty stripes—the *demi venu* of eighteen to twenty—or the *petit venu* of twelve to fifteen: after this they kiss the threshold and go in. Some are treated with the same compliment at discharge. The like ceremony is observed at many other towns in Germany.

MENTZ. In the house of correction all was neat, and showed the attention of the regency. On my taking notice to the keeper how clean his prison was, he said, "How can it be otherwise, when we have so many women prisoners? Surely they must keep the house clean?" Most of the flour in the city is ground at a mill in this prison; at which the delinquents work two hours in the morning, and two in the afternoon. Over the door is carved a wagon drawn by two stags, two lions, and two wild boars; with an inscription explaining the device, which is, that if even wild beasts can be tamed to the yoke,

we should not despair of reclaiming irregular men. I saw the same bas relief at one or two other houses of correction.

LIÈGE. The two prisons (distinguished by the names of the old and the new) near La Porte de St. Leonard in Liège, are on the ramparts. In two rooms of the old prison I saw six cages made very strong with iron hoops, four of which were empty. (The dimensions were seven feet by six feet nine inches, and six feet and a half high. On one side was an aperture of six inches by four, for giving in the victuals.) These were dismal places of confinement, but I soon found worse. In descending deep below ground from the gaoler's apartments, I heard the moans of the miserable wretches in the dark dungeons. The sides and roof were all stone. In wet weather, water from the fosses gets into them, and has greatly damaged the floors. Each of them had two small apertures, one for admitting air, and another, with a shutter over it strongly bolted, for putting in food to the prisoners. One dungeon larger than the rest was appropriated to the sick. In looking into this, with a candle, I discovered a stove, and felt some surprise at this little escape of humanity from the men who constructed these cells.

The dungeons in the new prison are abodes of misery still more shocking; and confinement in them so overpowers human nature, as sometimes irrecoverably to take away the senses. I heard the cries of the distracted as I went down to them. One woman, however, I saw, who (as I was told) had sustained this horrid confinement forty-seven years without becoming distracted.

The cries of the sufferers in the torture-chamber may be heard by passengers without, and guards are placed to prevent them from stopping and listening. A physician and surgeon always attend when the torture is applied; and on a signal given by a bell the gaoler brings in wine, vinegar, and water to prevent the sufferers from expiring. "The tender mercies of the wicked are cruel." Thus in the Spanish inquisition, the physician and surgeon attend to determine the utmost extremity of suffering without expiring under the torture.

I will only add, that in this prison there are rooms appropriated to prisoners *en pension*; that is, to such as are confined by the magistrates, at the desire of their parents, guardians or relations. A shocking practice! which prevails also in some of the neighbouring countries.